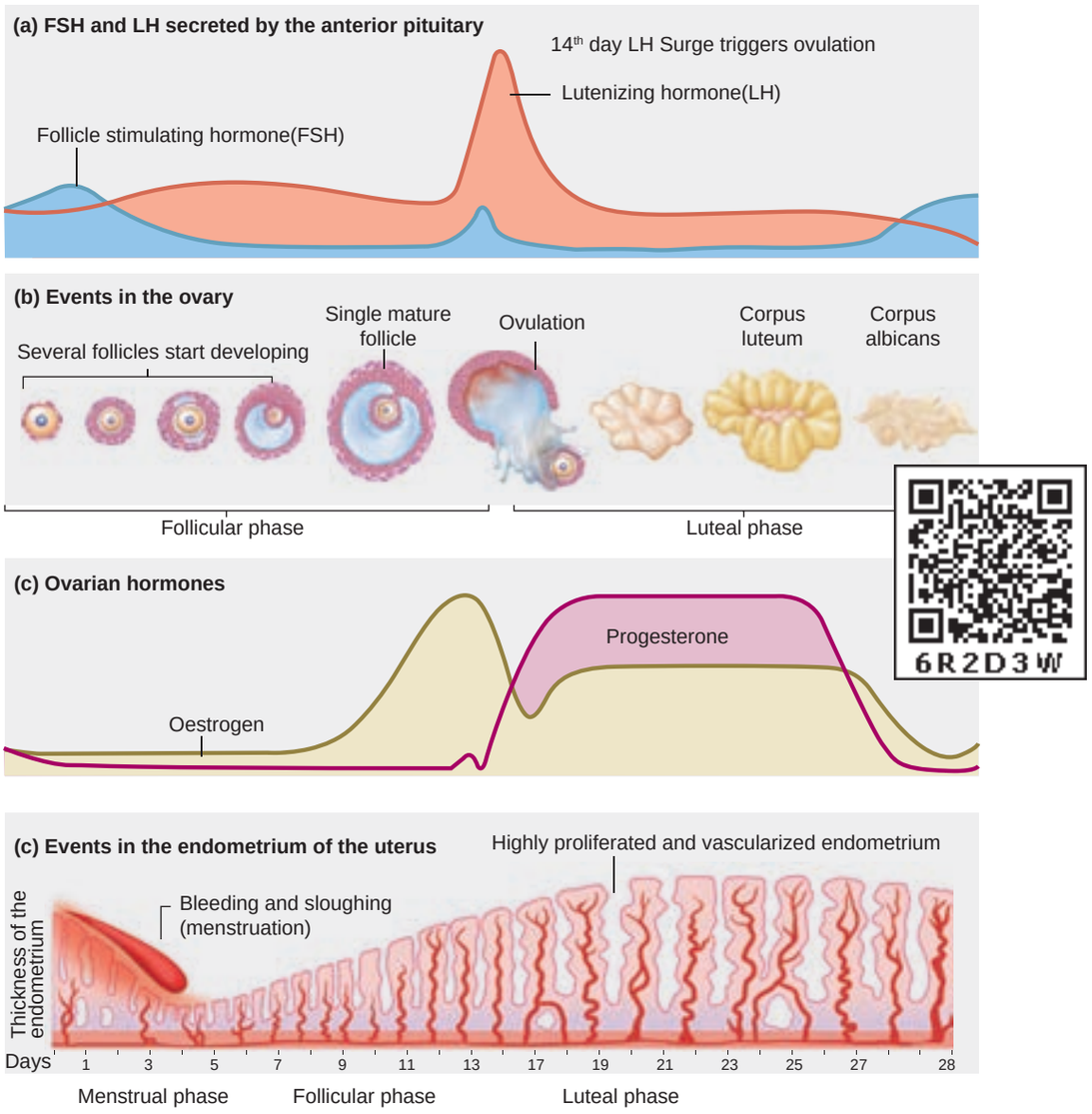


Fig. 2.9 Different phases of the menstrual cycle

the implantation of the fertilized ovum. The uterine wall secretes nutritious fluid in the uterus for the foetus. So, this phase is also called as **secretory phase.** During pregnancy all events of menstrual cycle stop and there is no menstruation.

In the absence of Fertilization, the corpus luteum degenerates completely and leaves a scar tissue called **corpus albicans**. It also initiates the disintegration of the endometrium leading to menstruation, marking the next cycle.

POLY CYSTIC OVARY SYNDROME (PCOS)

PCOS is a complex endocrine system disorder that affects women in their reproductive years. Polycystic means 'many cysts'. It refers to many partially formed follicles on the ovaries, which contain an egg each. But they do not grow to maturity or produce eggs that can be fertilized. Women with PCOS may experience irregular menstrual cycles, increased androgen levels, excessive facial or body hair growth (**hirsutism**), acne, obesity, reduced fertility and increased risk of diabetes. Treatment for PCOS includes a healthy lifestyle, weight loss and targeted hormone therapy.

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